i'll dial drunk, i'll die a drunk,

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/47136853.

Rating:
Mature

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora & Angella (She-Ra), Adora & Princesses (She-Ra), Catra & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Characters:
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Additional Tags:
Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Disaster Adora (She-Ra), Angst, Adora Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Hurt Adora (She-Ra), Adora Has Issues (She-Ra), Unhealthy Coping Mechanisms, Guilt, Redemption, Crying, Drinking, Drinking to Cope, Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner's A+ Parenting, Abusive Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Past Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Mentioned Angella (She-Ra), Death, She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018) Season 3

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Part 1 of Adora Dies (Nothing is the Same)

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by Lukaswritesthings

Summary

i'd die for you.

or; adora feels wrongfully guilty about her past with catra and goes to the extremes to make up for it/my take on adora's thoughts on her and catra post season 3

Notes

not even out yet and this song has a CHOKE HOLD on me (title is from dial drunk by noah kahan)

See the end of the work for more notes

Adora knew that she had done nothing wrong.

Even if she had, she was fighting for the good guys, she *was* a good guy. Logically she knew she wasn't a bad person.

But *god* if Catra's words had not gotten to her nothing else would have.

Technically she *was* at fault. If she had never left Catra, if she had been a bit more convincing, if Adora had just been better, Angella would still be alive.

That's what Adora found herself thinking each time she spent her night hours in the training room, punching the bags until her knuckles bled and her hands shook. Until her mind fogged from exhaustion and the pain of her sharp thoughts became dull. Until all she could do was sigh heavily and take another drink of her stolen whiskey.

She remembered a time when Angella would have been wandering the halls and would've found her half-dead before the sun rose, cradling a bottle of whiskey in the corner of the room behind a stack of weights. When she would've cleaned her up, laid her in her own bed, and placed tylenol and water next to her for the migraine that came with a hangover.

Now, Angella was gone. She was gone and Adora was still here, still falling asleep after getting drunk, but now she was waking up on a cold floor, with no way to treat the pain. *She* had caused it, *she* had let Angella take the sword and *she* had gotten Angella killed.

All the more reason to drink.

That was where she found herself tonight, taking a swig from the whiskey bottle, shaking her head like a rabid dog, and swinging at the punching bag again. And again. And again. And one more time before she growled lowly to herself and flopped onto a chair against the wall.

"Fucking stupid." Adora grumbled under her breath, rubbing her temples with her index fingers, trying to gently coax the fog into her brain quicker.

Her gray tank top was soaked with sweat, both from exertion and from the rude awakening she had had earlier caused by nightmares. Her night shorts were wrinkled and stained with some alcoholic beverage she couldn't remember drinking, not that she truly cared. Most of her wardrobe smelt of alcohol, and she was sure the others could tell, too.

She questioned why none of them confronted her, but she could tell they suspected something from the half-concerned-half-disbelieving glances she got.

The slow drag of footsteps brought her from her thoughts as she looked up, watching Glimmer stop and stare at her for a second before coming and sitting next to her. Adora tensed, readying for the inevitable yelling match.

"I didn't know you drank." It was almost imperceptible, but Adora caught the whisper that fell from Glimmer's lips.

She gulped, rubbing a fist over her eyes. "Really?"

"Nope." There was a threatening, looming silence that meant to destroy Adora before Glimmer continued. "When did you start?"

"A little bit before I left the Horde. It was something fun to do, a little way to rebel against the rules but, I don't know. It's an easy out, I guess." Adora struggled to find the words to describe the calm numbness she got from her whiskey. The dizzy giddiness she felt as it set in, the way she smiled and stumbled around the room as she felt the effects of the alcohol.

Glimmer shifted, placing her elbows on her knees and her head in her hands. "Did... did my mom know?" Her voice warbled, and Adora's heart ached as she thought of the way Glimmer must have felt. *Her fault again.* Adora took another drink.

"Yeah." She smacked her lips together, savoring the burn in her throat. "She helped me a lot." Adora left it at that, and it seemed Glimmer was content to do the same.

"We've got a mission tomorrow. You should be resting." Glimmer sat up straight, looking towards Adora. She swallowed roughly, meeting Glimmer's harsh eyes.

"I could say the same to you." Adora looked Glimmer up and down. There were dark eyebags under her light brown eyes, eyebags that she was sure were mirrored on her own face. Her cheeks were red and puffy, and Adora's heart ached again. Angella had died, Catra had pulled the lever, Glimmer had to be queen *and* mourn her mother at the same time, and Adora had somehow caused all of it. *Another drink.*

"A queen never rests until her kingdom is safe."

Adora paused mid drink, setting the bottle down and slowly swallowing. She had remembered Angella telling her that as they found each other in the winding hallways, both walking around to burn off the extra thoughts and energy before bed. She remembered looking up at the mighty queen and admiring her determination.

She could see Glimmer pause too, staring at her hands before covering her eyes. Her head was down, propped up by her hands. Adora startled as she heard Glimmer sniffle, a distressed hand reaching down to rub the new queen's back.

"*God*, I miss her." Glimmer said, and if Adora had the will, she would've downed the whole bottle of whiskey right then.

-*-

Adora knew her guilt went back *much* farther than leaving the Horde. It went back to the years After finding Catra in the box.

Her guilt stemmed from the days when Catra asked her to cover for her at training because she was exhausted from Shadow

Weaver. The times Adora found Catra curled up in a ball in some corner, bruises littering her body and cuts covering her face due to Shadow Weaver.

Adora *could* have done *something*. She could have protested against their mentor more, stayed behind and been more rebellious, kept Catra safe. It seemed the only thing she was good at was running. *She wished she had a bottle of whiskey.*

Adora tossed and turned in bed, searching for a part that wasn't warm and damp with her sweat. She groaned, covering her eyes.

Catra had been troubled from some point in her youth, but when exactly? How could Adora ever forgive herself for not keeping Catra safe? How could she ever be redeemed? The truth was, Adora couldn't. She had left her only family for people she hardly knew, had left her unprotected even when she was physically close to her.

Adora sighed. The only sound in her room was the creak of the rusty hinge of her window as a breeze flowed through, covering her in a cold sorrow.

Adora needed to do something to redeem herself. Being apart of the good guys wasn't enough to save her from whatever damnation she was destined for. She needed something big, something that meant *something*.

If only she had protected Catra properly.

-*-

Adora growled lowly, sending a heavy-handed punch towards a soldiers helmet. Her knuckles stung, but she made up for it by kicking the next one that came towards her. She was running on pure human energy, her limbs aching and her bones creaking.

She glanced around the field, searching for something to do. *Someone,* her mind supplied.

She spotted Catra towards the back, away from the main battle. A stupid hope rose in her that Catra was waiting for her, but she saw the smirk on Catra's face and scowled.

Adora began the slow march towards the commander, taking out any soldier that crossed her path. Her eyes were fixed on Catra, stuck on the one girl who could absolutely ruin her with two words. Guilt rose in her, turning to anger as it reached her heart and back to guilt by the time she registered it.

"Catra!" Adora yelled out, her voice rough with rage. She was running now, but stumbled when she saw something.

A robot had appeared behind the magicat, it's gun point towards her. It was deformed, and had obviously malfunctioned, but Catra seemed too focused on the battle to notice.

"*Catra!*" Adora let out a strangled scream. She ran faster than she had ever before as the robot loaded up it's shot. Finally, Catra, looked her way, her eyes widening as she saw the robot behind her. It was about to go off, and Adora just needed to make it 30 more feet, *29 more feet, the laser was visible, 18 more feet, it was going to kill her, 10 more feet, she need to save her, finally protect her, 5 more feet-*

Adora jumped the last few feet, holding her arms out and pushing them against Catra's body, watching as she went flying. Adora could've sworn she saw herself glow for a second before the laser sounded off, and her stomach exploded in a fiery flame.

-*-

As Adora opened her eyes, she regretted not dying. At least, she didn't think she was dead.

She could feel the grass underneath her, the fire radiating from the coldest spot in the middle of her stomach.

Adora gasped, trying to move her arm to grasp her chest in pain, but found she could move nothing.

"*Adora!*" She could hear a familiar voice screech, and Glimmer's face burst into view.

"Adora, *holy fuck-,* god damnit! Shit, Frosta! Run, get Castaspella *now!*" Glimmer screamed, though her voice sounded muddled to Adora.

"*Glimmer?*" She asked, but it sounded more like a whisper.

Glimmer shushed her, tears flowing from her eyes.
"Quiet, *quiet,* it'll be okay, *please*." She pleaded, her eyes darting all over Adora's body.

Adora could assume she wasn't a pretty sight after being shot with a laser that left a 1x1 foot hole in a concrete wall.

"Glimmer-" Adora coughed, watching specks of blood hit Glimmer's arm. Glimmer stared, wide eyed and shaking, at the massive amount of blood continously spilling from Adora's abdomen. Adora felt more guilt flooding her. *She wished she had whiskey.*

"Are the others okay?" Adora whispered. *Catra.*

"Only you, *only you.*" Glimmer responded, cupping Adora's face.

Adora leaned into the touch as much as she could, feeling the wetness slip across her face.

"Good." Adora muttered, letting her head fall away from Glimmer's shaking hand.

"I love you, Glim." Adora said, hearing Glimmer's guttural scream and sob.

"*Castaspella!"* Glimmer begged, looking around wildly before settling back on Adora. The woman stared at her best friend for moments before leaning over her, placing her forehead against her muddied shoulder.

"I love you too, Adora." She whispered, pressing her lips to Adora's shoulder. She didn't see the pained smile on Adora's face as her eyes closed.

"Tell the others I love them too, okay?" Adora breathed out, unsure if Glimmer actually heard her.

Adora felt the sleep of forever come over her, exhaustion filling her bones as the pain faded away.

Glancing around for one final time, she saw Catra in the tree line. Her eyes were wide and tears were flowing from them freely as her whole body shook. She was in clear pain as she stared at Adora's bleeding form.

Adora wished she had whiskey.

End Notes

the use of italics in this story needs to be scientifically studied stg

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